

Final Written Report Guidelines

CEVE 421/521 Final Project

2026-05-01

Draft Material — This content is under development and subject to change.

1 Overview

Due: Finals Period (date TBD)

The Written Report is the capstone of your audit project. It synthesizes your two memos and incorporates feedback from your Executive Briefing into a polished final deliverable.

2 Requirements

Submit a **5-7 page report** (PDF, excluding references) containing:

3 Executive Summary (1 page max)

A standalone summary that a busy decision-maker could read in 5 minutes:

- What plan was audited?
- What are the key findings?
- What is your recommendation?

4 Introduction (0.5-1 page)

- Context: What is the plan? Who commissioned it?
- Scope: What aspects did you audit?
- Approach: How did you conduct the audit?

5 XLRM Framework Analysis (1-1.5 pages)

Synthesize and expand on Memo 1:

- Key Uncertainties (X) and how they're characterized
- Key Levers (L) and their ranges
- System Models / Relationships (R) and their assumptions
- Key Metrics (M) and their definitions
- Assessment of framework completeness
- Incorporate any feedback from presentation Q&A

6 Evidence & Robustness Analysis (1-1.5 pages)

Synthesize and expand on Memo 2:

- Valuation methods and their appropriateness
- Robustness assessment and vulnerabilities
- How well the plan handles deep uncertainty
- Incorporate any feedback from presentation Q&A

7 Recommendation (0.5-1 page)

Your final verdict with specific, actionable guidance:

- **Endorse / Modify / Reject** (with clear justification)
- Specific recommendations for improvement (if Modify)
- Alternative approaches (if Reject)

8 References

Cite all sources using AGU reference style, consistent with your memos.

9 Formatting Requirements

- **Length:** 5-7 pages (excluding references)
- **Font:** 11pt or larger
- **Margins:** 1 inch
- **Spacing:** Single or 1.5 spacing
- **Format:** PDF

10 What's New vs. Memos

The report is not just your two memos stapled together. You should:

1. **Synthesize:** Draw connections across both analyses
2. **Incorporate Feedback:** Address questions raised during your presentation
3. **Refine:** Improve clarity and depth based on instructor feedback on memos
4. **Polish:** Professional writing and formatting

11 Submission

Submit your report as a PDF to Canvas by 11:59 PM on the due date.

12 Grading Rubric

Criterion	Points
Executive Summary (clear, standalone)	10
XLRM Framework Analysis (depth, accuracy)	25
Evidence & Robustness Analysis (depth, accuracy)	25
Recommendation (justified, specific)	15
Writing Quality (clarity, organization)	15

Criterion	Points
Formatting and References	10
Total	100

Bibliography